

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Count Luchino Nefaria

OCCUPATION

Criminal; former head of Nefaria "family" of Maggia

BASE

Various, including castle originally located in Italy and reconstructed in the New Jersey Palisades.

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in

WEIGHT 230 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Black

FIRST APPEARANCE

The Avengers #13 (Feb. 1965)

POWERS

Superhuman strength, speed, and resistance to injury; projects laser beams from eyes; regenerates after injury; drains energy from other beings powered by ionic energy.

COUNT NEFARIA

Italian nobleman Count Luchino Nefaria used his fortune both to finance technological research and to make himself a power in the MAGGIA crime syndicate. Nefaria's wife Renata died giving birth to their daughter Giulietta. Growing up in America as Whitney Frost, Giulietta would eventually become the Maggia leader called MADAME MASQUE. In retaliation for the AVENGERS' opposition to the Maggia, Nefaria framed them for treason. The Avengers were cleared, but Nefaria was publicly exposed as a criminal. Among his grandest schemes, Nefaria captured Washington DC and held it for ransom, and later took over the North American Defense Command base at Valhalla Mountain. On both occasions he was thwarted by the X-MEN.



Thunderbird, a Native American member of the X-Men, perished while trying to prevent Count Nefaria's escape from Valhalla Mountain.



IN ALL VALHALLA BARGE, MY CHILDREN, WE SIX ARE THE ONLY ONES STILL CONSCIOUS, AND ONCE AGAIN, COUNT NEFARIA IS TRIUMPHANT...

THIS TIME TO HOLD THE FATE OF A WORLD IN HIS HANDS.

Later, Nefaria had Prof. Kenneth Sturdy endow him with the powers of the LIVING LASER, POWER MAN, and WHIRLWIND and again battled the Avengers. Soon afterwards, however, Nefaria aged into an ancient invalid, and seemingly died when his body was crushed. However, Nefaria revived as a superhuman powered by ionic energy, and continues to menace the entire world. **PS**



CRAZY GANG

- 1 Jack of Hearts 2 Jester
3 Tweedledope 4 Executioner
5 Red Queen

CRAZY GANG

FIRST APPEARANCE Marvel Super Heroes #377 (Sept. 1981)

BASE Mobile

MEMBERS AND POWERS

Executioner A hooded, scythe-wielding humanoid robot.

Jester Accomplished swordsman.

Knave Possesses superhuman strength.

Red Queen Her insanity twists all reality into negative situations.

Tweedledope Idiot-savant who devises advanced machinery.

The Crazy Gang is a team of professional criminals from another dimension (Earth-238, or the Crooked World) who look like characters from children's storybooks. They were assembled by that dimension's CAPTAIN BRITAIN (called Captain UK, real name: James Jaspers).

When the Crazy Gang was transported to the Earth of the Captain Britain, who was really Brian Braddock, they proved incompetent at committing crimes and so advertised for a new leader. They were taken over by Captain Britain's foe the Slaymaster, who masterminded a series of spectacular crimes which the Crazy Gang carried out for him. They were then recruited by master assassin Arcade to abduct Courtney Ross, the former girlfriend of Captain Britain. Ross managed to escape from the bumbling group, but was taken prisoner by Arcade himself. The Crazy Gang later clashed with EXCALIBUR, who subsequently allowed them to remain in this dimension. **MT**



Nefaria was the villain in the 1975 issue that relaunched the X-Men Super Heroes.